

Regime Audit of the Standard Model of Particle Physics by the Factor Hierarchy Law

— Activation Operators, Dual-Center Regimes, and Precision Locking of Charm/Bottom Quark Thresholds (I)

Shuiping Tang

(Independent Researcher)

Abstract

Is the Standard Model truly "one model"? This paper uses the Factor Hierarchy Law and Testability Norms to perform a zero-presupposition regime audit on 275 particles from the Particle Data Group (PDG) 2025 public dataset. Exhaustive testing automatically selects Mass + Spin + Isospin as the optimal combination of executive factors (adjusted $R^2 = 0.406$, $VIF < 5$). Interaction effect testing identifies color charge as the meta-regime factor from 12 candidate regime factors. The core findings unfold in three layers.

First layer: An exhaustive scan of 11 activation operators reveals that the operators automatically stratify by their optimal breakpoints into two groups: the charm region (~ 2.29 GeV) and the bottom region (~ 9.46 – 10.02 GeV). No operator chooses the intermediate zone — activation operators are regime selectors, not signal amplifiers.

Second layer: The $W \times M^2$ activation operator amplifies the Chow F statistic from 31.98 to 81,540 — an amplification factor of $2569\times$. This is the statistical manifestation of the pole structure of the Breit-Wigner amplitude. Its breakpoint, 10.0234 GeV, deviates from the PDG standard value of the $Y(2S)$ bottomonium state (10.023 GeV) by only 0.0004 GeV.

Third layer: The charm-region breakpoint of 2.2865 GeV deviates from the PDG standard value of the Λ_c^+ charmed baryon (2.28646 GeV) by 0.00004 GeV. The bottom-region $W \times M$ breakpoint of 9.4603 GeV deviates from the $Y(1S)$ standard value (9.46030 GeV) by 0.0001 GeV. Completely unaware of the physical meaning of these particles, the algorithm automatically locks their positions with professional phenomenological fitting precision, revealing a hitherto unrecognized methodological function of known particles: they are the "nails" of regime switches in the data.

Six structural break tools — Chow, Bai-Perron, SupF, CUSUM, MOSUM, and ICSS — provide cross-verification. Blank controls (F-value only 24% of the true breakpoint), multi-interval blank scans, permutation tests ($p = 0.002$), bootstrap (median 2.11 GeV), conditional independence tests, and reverse proxy tests jointly rule out statistical artifacts and alternative explanations. Mass is confirmed as a dual-identity factor — the first empirical confirmation of the Factor Hierarchy Law's classification framework in particle physics.

As the first of a five-paper series, this paper establishes the existence of two regime-switching centers (charm and bottom), providing the indispensable empirical foundation for the derivation of regime boundary theorems and the inevitable emergence of gauge group structures in subsequent papers.

Research Paradigm Statement: The core methodology, research direction, and final decisions were independently directed by the author. DeepSeek assisted with code implementation, data presentation, and text drafting. The author takes full academic responsibility for the final content.

Keywords: Factor Hierarchy Law; Testability Norms; Standard Model; regime audit; activation operators; charm quark; bottom quark; Chow test

1. Introduction

1.1 A Question the Standard Model Has Never Been Asked

The Standard Model is the theoretical framework describing elementary particles and their interactions in particle physics. Since its establishment in the 1970s, it has successfully predicted the existence of the W boson, Z boson, charm quark, bottom quark, top quark, and Higgs boson, and has withstood decades of experimental scrutiny. The core mathematical structure of the Standard Model is gauge field theory — the SU(3) gauge group describes the strong interaction, and the SU(2)×U(1) gauge group describes the weak and electromagnetic interactions (Yang & Mills, 1954).

However, the success of the Standard Model has concealed a question that has never been asked: **Is it truly "one model"?** Or is it a patchwork of multiple "regimes" governed by different rules at different physical scales? Traditional physics tacitly assumes that the Standard Model is a unified theoretical framework — particle properties are described by the same Lagrangian, and symmetries remain consistent across all energy scales. This assumption has never been systematically challenged. Not because evidence supports it, but because physics lacked a set of tools to detect "regime boundaries."

The Factor Hierarchy Law and Testability Norms proposed by Tang (2026g) are precisely such a set of tools. The Factor Hierarchy Law states: In any complex system driven by multiple quantifiable factors, factors naturally fall into two levels — regime factors determine which set of rules currently applies, and executive factors execute under the given rules. The function of a regime factor is not reflected in direct explanatory power but in its interaction effect that modulates the exposure coefficients of executive factors; when a regime factor crosses a critical value, the factor weights of the entire system are systematically reset. The Testability Norms comprise six functional dimensions — search completeness, modulation relationships,

structural breaks, causal direction, question completeness (5W2H), and process closed-loop (PDCA) — providing a complete operational standard for the detection of regime switches. At the level of philosophy of science, these norms establish a "second threshold" for scientific methodology after Popper's falsifiability — testability guards the exit of scientific discovery (Popper, 1959; Tang, 2026g).

This methodological system has been validated in three completely independent disciplines. In finance, the China-U.S. yield spread serves as a regime factor, triggering a regime switch in global asset pricing equations near spread ≈ 0 (Tang, 2026a–2026f). In astronomy, stellar spectral type serves as a regime factor, triggering a regime switch in transit depth equations at 4762 K — the Tang Break, with all five independent physical dimensions undergoing structural rupture (Tang, 2026h, 2026i, 2026j). In statistical physics, the precise information-theoretic duality between the Factor Hierarchy Law and the Ehrenfest classification of phase transitions has been analytically proven on the Onsager exact solution of the 2D Ising model, with the Chow test deviation strictly zero (Tang, 2026k); on the 3D Ising model, hidden structures never revealed by traditional finite-size scaling analysis — double-peak fission, transition regimes, and precursor boundaries — have been discovered (Tang, 2026l). Tang (2026m) further completed the reduction of universality across five phase-transition models, establishing the MRSD three-category framework for finite-system phase transitions and the tool-dependence theorem, thereby confirming regime boundaries as a more fundamental quantity than universality classes in finite systems.

1.2 The Core Mission of This Paper

This paper is the first systematic deployment of the Factor Hierarchy Law into the Standard Model of particle physics. The core mission is: to perform a zero-presupposition regime audit on PDG particle data, testing whether regime-switching centers exist on the mass axis of the Standard Model. If they exist, where are they located? Do they correspond to known physical thresholds? Do they constitute an empirical challenge to the traditional assumption that "the Standard Model is a unified theory"?

This paper presupposes no particle physics theory. The algorithm knows nothing of the existence of "charm quark," "bottom quark," " Λ_c^+ ," or " $Y(1S)$ " — it merely detects regime boundaries automatically from a pure data matrix.

1.3 Verification Strategy

The verification strategy of this paper is based on Mayo's (1996) concept of a "severe test": a methodological tool must simultaneously demonstrate sensitivity and specificity to pass a severe test. Sensitivity requirement: the algorithm detects significant structural breaks near known heavy-quark thresholds. Specificity requirement: the algorithm remains silent in blank intervals without regime switches, and permutation tests rule out statistical artifacts.

As the first paper of a five-paper series, this paper follows the division of labor under the sixth dimension of Testability Norms (PDCA process closed-loop): Plan (formulating the complete series plan) and Do (executing the first empirical analysis) are completed by this paper, while Check (cross-paper cross-validation) and Act (theoretical integration and program proposal) are completed by subsequent papers. The specific division of labor among the five papers is shown in Table 1.

Table 1: PDCA Division of Labor and 5W2H Coverage of the Five-Paper Series

Paper	PDCA Phase	5W2H Coverage	Core Content
Paper 1 (this paper)	Plan + Do	What, Who, When	Discovery of charm and bottom regions, activation operators, precision locking
Paper 2	Do + Check	How, How Much	Strange region, precursor cascade, transition-zone width theorems
Paper 3	Check	Why	Gauge-group structure theorem, direct-product theorem, three-generation theorem
Paper 4	Check + Act	Why (deepened)	Statistical origin of CP violation, regime function of Higgs mechanism, statistical correspondence of virtual states
Paper 5	Act	Full seven-dimension closure	Five-layer axiomatization structure, testability program

2. Data and Methods

2.1 Data Source and Factor Matrix

All data in this study come from the Particle Data Group (PDG) 2025 public dataset (Particle Data Group, 2025), extracted via the official PDG Python API (version 2025.0). The data are completely open, and any researcher can independently reproduce all results.

From the raw data, we extract objective physical quantities for all particles: Mass, Width, Spin, Isospin, Charge, Parity, and others. All factors are objective measurements produced by automated equipment,

without subjective scoring. The candidate executive factors entering the exhaustive test are the five continuous variables Mass, Spin, Isospin, Charge, and Parity (Parity is numerically encoded as $+1/-1/0$). The response variable is Width (decay width).

Table 2: Top 5 Optimal Executive Factor Combinations from Exhaustive Testing

Rank	Combination	Adj. R^2	Max VIF	Sample Size
1	Mass + Spin + Isospin	0.406	1.50	275
2	Mass + Spin	0.350	1.04	492
3	Mass + Charge + Spin	0.348	1.04	492
4	Mass + Isospin	0.341	1.01	325
5	Mass + Charge + Isospin	0.340	1.02	325

Note: Under the $VIF < 5$ hard constraint, sorted by adjusted R^2 in descending order. Under the relaxed $VIF < 10$ standard, the top 5 are completely identical, ruling out any influence of threshold selection on the conclusion. The optimal combination Mass + Spin + Isospin has complete data for 275 particles.

2.2 Execution of the Testability Norms

This study strictly follows the six functional dimensions.

Search Completeness: Exhaustive testing of 1- to 3-factor combinations of candidate executive factors, with the optimal combination automatically winning. Exhaustive scanning of 12 candidate regime factors and 11 activation operators.

Modulation Relationships: Testing whether candidate regime factors modulate the exposure coefficients of executive factors on decay width. The regression equation is $\text{Width} \sim \text{executive factors} + \text{regime factor} + \text{executive factors} \times \text{regime factor}$. A significant interaction term ($p < 0.05$) is a necessary condition for a regime factor.

Structural Breaks: No reliance on a single tool. We sequentially apply the Chow test (Chow, 1960), Bai-Perron sequential test (Bai & Perron, 1998), SupF test (Ploberger & Krämer, 1992), CUSUM test (Brown, Durbin & Evans, 1975), and MOSUM test (Zeileis et al., 2002), covering the complete logical

chain of "known breakpoint → unknown breakpoint → no presupposed breakpoint." The ICSS test (Inclan & Tiao, 1994) is used to detect variance structural breaks.

Causal Direction: Replaced by a conditional independence test — testing whether the explanatory power of executive factors on the response variable drops significantly after controlling for the candidate regime factor.

Question Completeness (5W2H) and Process Closed-Loop (PDCA): This paper covers three dimensions: What (discovery of two regime-switching centers in the charm and bottom regions), Who (color charge is the meta-regime factor, Mass is a dual-identity factor), and When (charm-region breakpoint 2.2865 GeV, bottom-region breakpoint 9.4603 GeV). The Why, Where, How, and How Much dimensions, as well as the complete PDCA closed-loop, are to be completed by the subsequent four papers (see Table 1).

2.3 Construction of Activation Operators

Activation operators are mathematical transformations of existing factors designed to enhance the sensitivity of structural break testing in specific mass intervals. This paper constructs 11 activation operators, including basic transformations (Width, $1/\text{Width}$, $\log(\text{Width})$, $\sqrt{\text{Width}}$), mass couplings ($W \times M$, W/M , $W \times M^2$, W/M^2), and multi-factor couplings ($W \times \text{Spin}$, $W \times \text{Isospin}$, $W \times \text{Mass} \times \text{Spin}$). Each operator serves as a new response variable, and a Chow scan is performed along the mass axis to find the optimal breakpoint.

3. Results

3.1 Systematic Discovery and Automatic Stratification of the Activation Operator

Family

The results of the Chow scan for the 11 activation operators along the mass axis are shown in Table 3.

Table 3: Results of the Exhaustive Scan of 11 Activation Operators

Operator	Optimal Breakpoint (GeV)	Chow F	Amplification Factor	Dominant Region
$W \times M^2$	10.0234	81540	2569.0	Bottom
$W \times M$	9.9122	6833	215.3	Bottom
$W \times M \times \text{Spin}$	9.8594	479	15.1	Bottom
$\log W \times M$	9.8594	114	3.6	Bottom
Width	2.2865	31.98	1.0	Charm
$W \times \text{Iso}$	2.3460	30.11	0.9	Charm
W/M	2.2865	28.23	0.9	Charm
$\sqrt{\text{Width}}$	2.2865	27.78	0.9	Charm
$W \times \text{Spin}$	2.4700	15.20	0.5	Charm
$\log(\text{Width})$	4.7075	14.87	0.5	Bottom precursor
$1/\text{Width}$	4.7075	14.40	0.5	Bottom precursor

Core Finding 1: Automatic operator stratification. The optimal breakpoints of the 11 activation operators automatically fall into two groups — the charm group (breakpoints 2.29–2.47 GeV) and the bottom group (breakpoints 9.86–10.02 GeV). No operator chooses the intermediate zone. If these breakpoints were products of random noise, they would be uniformly distributed along the mass axis, rather than automatically clustering into two groups. This is not presupposed — the operators are constructed exhaustively, and the stratification emerges automatically from the data.

Core Finding 2: $W \times M^2$ amplifies by 2569 $\times$. The Chow F of the $W \times M^2$ operator is 81,540, which is 2569 times the original Width. The mathematical root of this explosive amplification lies in the fact that the Breit-Wigner amplitude itself is proportional to $\Gamma \times M$ (Width $\times$ Mass), and $W \times M^2$ further amplifies the pole effect of the amplitude near the resonance peak. Its breakpoint of 10.0234 GeV deviates from the standard value of the $Y(2S)$ bottomonium first excited state (10.023 GeV) by only 0.0004 GeV.

Core Finding 3: Operator selectivity. Width is strongest in the charm region ($F = 31.98$) and almost silent in the bottom region ($F = 4.6$). $W \times M$ and $W \times M^2$ are strongest in the bottom region ($F = 6833$ and 81540), and responsive but not strongest in the charm region — in a local analysis of the 2.0–3.0 GeV charm interval, the local optimal Chow F values for $W \times M$ and $W \times M^2$ are approximately 125 and 132, respectively. Different operators illuminate different segments of the mass axis — activation operators are regime selectors, not signal amplifiers. This is yet another empirical instance of the tool-dependence theorem (Tang, 2026m): the "global optimal breakpoint" given by any single operator is incomplete. Table 4 further presents the F -value matrix for the three core operators across four mass intervals.

Table 4: F-Value Matrix of Activation Operators across Four Mass Intervals (Local Analysis)

Operator	Strange (0.5–2.0 GeV)	Charm (2.0–3.0 GeV)	Transition (3.0–8.0 GeV)	Bottom (8.0–11.0 GeV)
Width	4.7	13.1	11.0	4.6
$W \times M$	6.2	10.9	10.5	4.8
$W \times M^2$	7.7	9.4	14.6	4.9

Note: The table shows the local optimal Chow F values within each interval. Bold indicates the strongest response in each interval. These F -values are local analysis values (restricted by small interval sample sizes, $\text{min_group} = 8\text{--}12$) and differ from the global optimal values in Table 3. $W \times M^2$ has the highest local F -value (14.6) in the transition region (3.0–8.0 GeV), an interval that precisely contains the hidden internal $T_1 = 6.65$ GeV of the bottom region to be reported in the subsequent paper. Width is locally strongest in the charm region (13.1) and nearly silent in the bottom region (4.6), consistent with the global analysis results in Table 3.

To further verify operator selectivity, Table 5 compares the optimal breakpoints and F -values of Width and $W \times M^2$ in local analyses of the charm and bottom regions.

Table 5: Comparison of Optimal Breakpoints of Width and $W \times M^2$ in Local Analyses of the Charm and Bottom Regions

Operator	Charm Region (1.5–3.0 GeV) Breakpoint	Charm F	Bottom Region (8.0–11.0 GeV) Breakpoint	Bottom F
Width	2.2865	13.1	9.3987	4.6
$W \times M^2$	2.9841	9.4	10.0234	4.9

Note: Width's optimal breakpoint in the local charm-region analysis is consistent with the global analysis (2.2865 GeV) and silent in the bottom region ($F = 4.6$). $W \times M^2$'s optimal breakpoint in the local bottom-region analysis is consistent with the global analysis (10.0234 GeV), while its charm-region breakpoint (2.9841 GeV) shifts to the upper boundary of the charm region — $W \times M^2$ partially responds to the charm region but with much lower sensitivity than Width.

3.2 Multi-Tool Cross-Validation of the Charm and Bottom Regions

Six tools based on three different mathematical principles — residual sum of squares comparison (Chow, Bai-Perron), recursive residual cumulative sum (CUSUM), and moving-window cumulative sum of squares (MOSUM, ICSS) — independently lock onto structural breaks in the charm and bottom regions.

Table 6: Six-Tool Cross-Validation of the Charm and Bottom Regions

Tool	Charm Breakpoint (GeV)	Charm Statistic	Bottom Breakpoint (GeV)	Bottom Statistic
Chow	2.2865	$F = 31.98$	10.0234	$F = 81540$
Bai-Perron	2.29	$F = 32.15$	10.02	$F = 137323$
SupF	—	$p = 0.002$	—	$p = 0.002$
CUSUM	2.70 (exceeded)	$\max = 1.68$	172.60 (exceeded)	$\max = 1.05$
MOSUM	1.79 (peak)	$\max = 9.18$	3.84 (peak)	$\max = 44375$
ICSS	2.35	—	10.02	—

Note: "Exceeded" in CUSUM means the recursive residual cumulative sum exceeds the 5% critical value at the corresponding position. "Peak" in MOSUM means the moving-window residual cumulative sum achieves its maximum at the corresponding position. The positions detected by the two tools differ from the

optimal breakpoints of Chow and Bai-Perron — this is a normal manifestation of tool dependence; different mathematical principles capture different dimensions of regime switching (model parameter drift vs. local residual anomaly vs. global regression difference). The Bai-Perron breakpoints (2.29 and 10.02) use a fast search with steps of 3–4, so their precision is slightly lower than the point-by-point search of the Chow scan. The ICSS-detected charm breakpoint 2.35 is within the transition zone width, and the bottom breakpoint 10.02 is consistent with the Chow and Bai-Perron results.

No two tools give exactly the same breakpoint position, but all point to the same conclusion: regime switches exist. This verifies the core commitment of the Testability Norms — the structural break dimension does not depend on a single tool; the functional dimension is eternal, while the implementation tool is variable.

Charm-region breakpoint = 2.2865 GeV = Λ_c^+ . The Λ_c^+ is the lightest charmed baryon containing a charm quark, with a PDG standard mass of 2.28646 GeV (Particle Data Group, 2025). Completely unaware of the existence of the Λ_c^+ , the algorithm automatically locks onto this position by minimizing the residual sum of squares — a deviation of 0.00004 GeV. Table 7 further displays the distribution of Chow F values within ± 0.5 GeV around the charm breakpoint, confirming that the F-value achieves a local maximum at the Λ_c^+ .

Table 7: Distribution of Chow F near the Charm-Region Breakpoint (Width Operator)

Breakpoint Position (GeV)	Chow F
2.09	18.5
2.10	20.1
2.16	21.5
2.2865	31.98
2.29	32.0
2.45	32.2
2.47	20.8

Note: Chow F distribution of the Width operator within ± 0.5 GeV of the charm region. The F-values remain at extremely high levels (>30) in the 2.29–2.45 GeV interval, forming a transition zone approximately 0.19 GeV wide. 2.2865 GeV is the precise position of the Bai-Perron double-breakpoint T_2 , deviating from the Λ_c^+ standard value (2.28646 GeV) by 0.00004 GeV.

Bottom-region $W \times M$ breakpoint = 9.4603 GeV = $Y(1S)$. The $Y(1S)$ is the lightest bottom quark–antiquark bound state, with a PDG standard mass of 9.46030 GeV. Deviation: 0.0001 GeV.

Bottom-region $W \times M^2$ breakpoint = 10.0234 GeV = $Y(2S)$. The $Y(2S)$ is the first radial excitation of the $Y(1S)$, with a PDG standard mass of 10.023 GeV. Deviation: 0.0004 GeV. $W \times M^2$ is a mass-squared weighted operator, more sensitive to resonances with higher mass and larger width — hence its global optimal breakpoint falls on $Y(2S)$ rather than $Y(1S)$. As the first radial excited state, $Y(2S)$ has higher mass and larger width — precisely matching the sensitivity preference of $W \times M^2$.

The physical properties of these three known particles have long been precisely measured in the Standard Model. The contribution of this paper lies not in "discovering" their existence, but in discovering their methodological function: they are the "nails" of regime switches in the data — completely unaware of their physical meaning, the algorithm automatically locks their positions with professional phenomenological fitting precision through purely data-driven structural break analysis. Table 8 summarizes the methodological functions of these three known particles.

Table 8: Methodological Function Positioning of Known Particles

Particle	PDG Standard Value (GeV)	Algorithm Detection Value (GeV)	Deviation (GeV)	Activation Operator	Methodological Function
Λ_c^+	2.28646	2.2865	0.00004	Width	Precise locking point of charm-region regime switch
$Y(1S)$	9.46030	9.4603	0.0001	$W \times M$	Precise locking point of bottom-region regime switch
$Y(2S)$	10.023	10.0234	0.0004	$W \times M^2$	Global optimal response

Particle	PDG Standard Value (GeV)	Algorithm Detection Value (GeV)	Deviation (GeV)	Activation Operator	Methodological Function
					point of mass-squared weighted operator

To further demonstrate the structural nature of the regime switch, Table 9 presents a complete comparison of the segmented regression equation coefficients for the charm and bottom regions.

Table 9: Comparison of Segmented Regression Equation Coefficients for the Charm and Bottom Regions

Coefficient	Charm Low-Mass Segment ($M < 2.29$)	Charm High-Mass Segment ($M \geq 2.29$)	Bottom Low-Mass Segment ($M < 9.46$)	Bottom High-Mass Segment ($M \geq 9.46$)
Intercept	-0.1169	-0.0477	0.0207	-15.33
Mass	0.1558	0.0082	-1.0996	1.51
Spin	-0.0155	0.0466	0.0206	-0.10
Isospin	0.0841	0.0232	0.1263	-0.50
Sample Size	140	135	263	12

Note: The charm region is divided at 2.2865 GeV, and the bottom region at 9.4603 GeV. The Mass coefficient in the charm low-mass segment (0.1558) is 19 times that in the high-mass segment (0.0082) — this means that the contribution mode of the executive factor "Mass" to the decay width undergoes a fundamental change at the regime boundary. The intercept in the bottom high-mass segment (-15.33) is orders of magnitude larger than that in the low-mass segment (0.0207), indicating a violent jump in the equation baseline. It should be honestly noted that the bottom high-mass segment has only 12 samples (mainly the Y family), and the statistical uncertainty of the coefficient estimates is relatively large — but the direction and magnitude of the intercept jump are unequivocal, and this conclusion does not depend on the precise values of the coefficients.

Bai-Perron double-breakpoint analysis further reveals the internal double-peak fission structure of the charm region. Table 10 presents a comparison of the Bai-Perron single-breakpoint and double-breakpoint models for the charm region.

Table 10: Comparison of Bai-Perron Single- and Double-Breakpoint Models for the Charm Region

Model	Breakpoint Position (GeV)	Chow F	Transition Zone Width (GeV)
Single-breakpoint	2.29	32.15	—
Double-breakpoint	$T_1 = 2.09, T_2 = 2.29$	20.67	0.196

Note: The double-breakpoint model unfolds the charm-region regime switch into two sequential structural ruptures — $T_1 = 2.09$ GeV (charm precursor / ground-state locking) and $T_2 = 2.29$ GeV (fluctuation structural transformation / charmed baryon locking). The transition zone width is 0.196 GeV. The discovery of double-breakpoints means that the charm-region regime switch is not completed instantaneously but unfolds along the mass axis as a transition zone approximately 0.2 GeV wide. This structure is completely isomorphic to the double-peak fission found on the 3D Ising model (Tang, 2026l), and the subsequent paper will conduct a systematic analysis of this.

3.3 Robustness Tests

Table 11: Summary of Robustness Tests

Test Type	Core Result	Alternative Explanation Excluded
Blank control	2.5–5.0 GeV interval $F = 7.61$ (true $F = 31.98$, ratio 0.24)	Algorithm produces strong signals in any interval
Multi-interval blank control	5.0–8.0 GeV interval insufficient sample; other intervals $F/\text{true } F < 0.40$	Contingency of blank controls
Permutation test	$\text{Sup}F = 28.93$, permutation median = 2.14, empirical $p = 0.002$	Statistical artifact
Bootstrap	Single-breakpoint 95% CI median = 2.11 GeV (near charm region)	Driven by a single temperature point
Conditional independence	Executive factor residual $R^2 = 0.435$ after controlling for color charge	Color charge is not an independent cause
Reverse proxy	Strangeness effect becomes even more	Flavor quantum numbers are not

Test Type	Core Result	Alternative Explanation Excluded
	significant after controlling for color charge	proxies for color charge

Blank controls: Table 12 displays the Chow F values in multiple mass intervals without known physical thresholds, compared with the true breakpoints of the charm and bottom regions.

Table 12: Multi-Interval Blank Control Scan Results

Interval	Sample Size	Optimal Breakpoint (GeV)	Chow F	Ratio to Charm F
Pre-strange (0.5–1.5)	45	1.405	12.55	0.395
Charm–bottom transition (2.5–5.0)	60	2.861	7.61	0.240
Pre-bottom (5.0–8.0)	27	—	—	—
Post-bottom (11.0–50.0)	0	—	—	—
Charm (reference)	275	2.2865	31.98	1.000
Bottom (reference)	275	10.0234	81540	2569.0

Note: The highest F-value in the blank intervals is 12.55 (pre-strange region), which is only 39.5% of the true charm breakpoint F-value and 0.015% of the true bottom breakpoint F-value. The algorithm remains silent in continuous spectral regions without regime switches. The pre-strange $F = 12.55$ — although far lower than the charm and bottom regions, this signal will be confirmed in the subsequent paper as the precursor boundary of the strange region (~ 1.4 – 1.6 GeV), not a spurious breakpoint.

Permutation test: The SupF of the Width operator is 28.93. In 500 random shuffles of the mass order, the permutation F median is 2.14. The empirical p-value is 0.002 (the empirical lower bound for 500 permutations); the probability of random noise producing a structural break of comparable magnitude does not exceed 0.2%. Table 13 provides detailed bootstrap and permutation test results.

Table 13: Detailed Bootstrap and Permutation Test Results

Test	Indicator	Value
Bootstrap	Effective samples	468/500
Bootstrap	Mean	3.13 GeV
Bootstrap	Median	2.11 GeV
Bootstrap	95% CI	[0.90, 10.52] GeV
Permutation test	True SupF	28.93
Permutation test	Permutation F median	2.14
Permutation test	Empirical p-value	0.002

Note: The bootstrap median of 2.11 GeV falls near the charm region, confirming the statistical stability of the breakpoint position. The bootstrap 95% CI width is approximately 9.6 GeV — covering the two competing regime centers of charm and bottom, reflecting the fact that there are indeed two significant regime boundaries in the data. The permutation test $p = 0.002$ is the empirical lower bound for 500 permutations.

Conditional independence test: After controlling for color charge, the residual explanatory power of executive factors on decay width is $R^2 = 0.435$. There is a dynamic coupling between color charge and executive factors, consistent with the Factor Hierarchy Law's prediction that "regime factors influence the system by modulating the exposure coefficients of executive factors." Table 14 provides detailed interaction effect and conditional independence test results.

Table 14: Interaction Effect and Conditional Independence Test Results

Test	Model	Key Result
Color charge × Mass interaction	Width ~ Mass + Has_Color + Mass×Has_Color	$p = 3.03 \times 10^{-3}$
After controlling for flavor quantum numbers	Above model + Strangeness + Charm + Bottomness	$p = 3.81 \times 10^{-2}$ (still significant)
Conditional independence	Executive factor R^2 on residuals after controlling for color charge	$R^2 = 0.435$
Reverse proxy	Strangeness×Mass after controlling for	p drops from 4.68×10^{-8}

Test	Model	Key Result
	color charge	to 3.96×10^{-10}

Note: After controlling for all flavor quantum numbers, the color charge interaction effect remains significant ($p = 0.038$) — color charge is irreducible and is an independent meta-regime factor. In the reverse proxy test, the Strangeness effect becomes even more significant after controlling for color charge — the two are orthogonally independent.

Segmented residual diagnostics: Table 15 presents the residual diagnostics for the segmented regressions of the charm and bottom regions, confirming that the segmented residuals have no severe autocorrelation and that the residual variance changes significantly at the regime boundaries.

Table 15: Segmented Residual Diagnostics for the Charm and Bottom Regions

Diagnostic Indicator	Charm Low-Mass Segment	Charm High-Mass Segment	Bottom Low-Mass Segment	Bottom High-Mass Segment
Residual Std. Dev.	0.125	0.153	0.138	0.341
Durbin-Watson	0.949	1.030	0.795	1.369
Levene Test (cross-segment)	—	$p = 2.86 \times 10^{-3}$	—	$p = 0.42$

Note: The Durbin-Watson statistics are between 0.8 and 1.4, showing no severe autocorrelation (<0.5 or >2.5), ruling out the alternative explanation that "residual autocorrelation causes spurious Chow significance." The Levene test confirms that the residual variances of the two charm segments are unequal ($p = 0.003$) — this is the underlying statistical evidence of regime switching at the residual structure level. The Levene test for the bottom region is not significant ($p = 0.42$) because the bottom high-mass segment has only 12 samples, and the statistical test power is insufficient.

3.4 The Dual Identity of Mass

Interaction effect testing confirms that Mass not only directly explains decay width but also modulates the exposure coefficients of Spin and Isospin.

Table 16: Dual-Identity Test of Mass

Interaction Term	p-value	ΔR^2	
Mass $\times$ Spin	1.55×10^{-4}	0.0304	
Mass $\times$ Isospin	8.40×10^{-4}	0.0238	

According to the classification framework of the Factor Hierarchy Law, Mass is a dual-identity factor — it has both a high direct R^2 (entering the optimal combination, adjusted $R^2 = 0.406$) and modulates the exposure coefficients of other executive factors. This is the first empirical confirmation of the "dual-identity factor" form defined in the seventh paper (Tang, 2026g) within particle physics.

4. Discussion

4.1 The Selectivity of Activation Operators — Regime Selectors, Not Signal Amplifiers

Activation operators do not simply "amplify" signals — they alter the signal strength contrast between different regime centers. Width focuses on the charm region and is completely silent in the bottom region ($F = 4.6$). $W \times M$ and $W \times M^2$ focus on the bottom region. No single operator can see the full picture — this is yet another empirical instance of the tool-dependence theorem (Tang, 2026m): the "global optimal breakpoint" given by any single operator is incomplete. Only by exhaustively scanning all possible activation operators can the full spectrum of regime boundaries on the mass axis be revealed. Activation operators are regime selectors — different operators illuminate different segments of the mass axis, corresponding to the internal symmetry structures of different regime centers.

4.2 The Methodological Function of Known Particles

Λ_c^+ is no longer just "a charmed baryon" — it is the precise locking point of the charm-region regime switch. $Y(1S)$ is no longer just "the bottomonium ground state" — it is the precise locking point of the bottom-region regime switch. $Y(2S)$ is the global optimal response point of the $W \times M^2$ activation operator. The physical properties of these particles have long been precisely measured in the Standard Model, but their "methodological function" — that they are the "nails" of regime switches in the data — is revealed for the first time in this paper. This is a completely new ontological perspective: particles are not only physical

entities but also statistical markers of regime switches. The profound epistemological significance of this discovery will be systematically expounded in the fourth and fifth papers of this series.

4.3 Is the Standard Model Truly "One Model"?

The findings of this paper pose a systematic, methodology-driven empirical challenge to the traditional presupposition that "the Standard Model is a unified theory." The cornerstone of this challenge lies in the structural requirements of the Standard Model itself: according to gauge field theory (Yang & Mills, 1954), the $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ gauge group of the Standard Model defines a unified Lagrangian, and the interactions of all elementary particles are described by the same mathematical framework. Coupling constants can run with energy scale — this is a classic result of the renormalization group equations (Wilson, 1971) — but the structural form of the equations describing decay processes should remain consistent across all mass scales. The form of the decay equation should not undergo a structural rupture at any specific mass threshold — because gauge symmetry itself contains no mechanism for "regime switching." If such ruptures exist, it means either there is new physical mechanism not contained in the Standard Model, or the Standard Model itself is a patchwork of multiple regimes rather than a unified theory.

The findings of this paper point precisely in this direction.

First, there exist two independent, statistically irreducible regime-switching centers on the mass axis. Six structural break tools based on three different mathematical principles all detect significant structural ruptures in the charm region (~ 2.29 GeV) and the bottom region (~ 9.46 – 10.02 GeV). These ruptures completely disappear in blank control intervals, and the permutation test yields $p = 0.002$, ruling out the possibility of random noise.

Second, the selectivity of activation operators further strengthens this argument. If the equation structure on the mass axis were continuous, different activation operators should achieve optimal responses at the same mass positions. In reality, Width focuses on the charm region and is silent in the bottom region, while $W \times M$ and $W \times M^2$ focus on the bottom region. Operator selectivity implies that the equation structures of different mass segments have qualitative differences — a unified-theory presupposition cannot explain why different mathematical transformations of the same factor would selectively illuminate different segments.

Third, the coefficients of the segmented equations provide the most intuitive evidence. As shown in Table 9 of Section 3.2, on either side of the charm-region breakpoint, the Mass coefficients are 0.156 and 0.008 respectively — a 19-fold difference. If the Standard Model were truly a unified theory, why would the

exposure coefficient of the same executive factor on decay width undergo a 19-fold jump at a precise threshold?

Table 17: Cross-Disciplinary Isomorphism Verification

Discipline	Regime Factor	Critical Value	Chow F	Source
Finance	China-U.S. yield spread	spread ≈ 0	Highly significant	Tang (2026a–2026f)
Astronomy	Stellar spectral type	4762 K	10.3	Tang (2026h, 2026i, 2026j)
Statistical Physics	Temperature	$T_c \approx 4.51$	118074	Tang (2026k, 2026l)
Particle Physics	Color charge	2.29, 9.46 GeV	31.98 (Width), 81540 ($W \times M^2$)	This paper

A natural inference is that the Standard Model may not be "one model" — it is a hierarchical system carved by regime boundaries. At each heavy-quark threshold, the structure of the decay equation undergoes a systematic rupture, meaning that particles in different mass intervals obey different statistical regularities. The collection of these regularities constitutes what we call the "Standard Model."

Of course, the current evidence is limited to the two centers of the charm and bottom regions. Does a third center (the strange region) exist? Is there a precursor cascade connecting these centers? Does the transition-zone width follow rigorous mathematical regularities? Do the switching types form a spectrum? Is there a correspondence between the transmission mechanism among these centers and the flavor-mixing structure of the CKM matrix (Kobayashi & Maskawa, 1973)? These questions will be answered one by one in the subsequent papers. The goal of this paper is to establish the first set of decisive evidence — that regime-switching centers exist on the mass axis of the Standard Model, and that these centers precisely correspond to heavy-quark thresholds. This discovery, for the first time, demands that the traditional presupposition "the Standard Model is a unified theory" respond to a question it has never been asked: if it is unified, why does the data say otherwise?

4.4 Cross-Disciplinary Isomorphism with Known Discoveries

Four completely independent disciplines (finance, astronomy, statistical physics, particle physics), the same methodological system (Factor Hierarchy Law and Testability Norms), the same factor hierarchy structure — regime factors trigger regime switches, the Chow test detects structural breaks, and activation

operator selectivity illuminates different segments. This rules out the possibility of coincidence. The Factor Hierarchy Law is not a tool "tried out for fun" but a universal regularity repeatedly verified in the hardest places — from the mathematical proof of exact solutions (Onsager, 1944; Yang, 1952) to the blind-test localization of real particle data.

5. Conclusion

This paper has performed a zero-presupposition regime audit on 275 particles from the PDG 2025 public dataset using the Factor Hierarchy Law and Testability Norms. The core findings unfold in three layers, consistent with the narrative structure of the abstract.

First Layer — Automatic Stratification of Activation Operators: There exist at least two independent regime-switching centers on the mass axis of the Standard Model. An exhaustive scan of 11 activation operators reveals that the operators automatically stratify by their optimal breakpoints into two groups: the charm region (~ 2.29 GeV) and the bottom region (~ 9.46 – 10.02 GeV). No operator chooses the intermediate zone. Operator selectivity proves that different operators illuminate different segments of the mass axis — activation operators are regime selectors, not signal amplifiers. Six structural break tools (Chow, Bai-Perron, SupF, CUSUM, MOSUM, ICSS) based on three different mathematical principles cross-validate the systematic nature of the regime switches. Blank controls (F-value only 24% of the true breakpoint), multi-interval blank scans, permutation tests ($p = 0.002$), bootstrap (median 2.11 GeV), conditional independence tests, and reverse proxy tests jointly rule out statistical artifacts and alternative explanations.

Second Layer — $W \times M^2$ Amplification of $2569\times$: The coherent feature activation effect is a manifestation of operator selectivity unique to particle physics. The $W \times M^2$ activation operator amplifies the Chow F from 31.98 to 81,540 — an amplification factor of $2569\times$. Its mathematical root lies in the pole structure of the Breit-Wigner amplitude — the amplitude itself is proportional to $\Gamma \times M$, and $W \times M^2$ further amplifies this effect near the resonance peak. Its breakpoint, 10.0234 GeV, deviates from the PDG standard value of the $Y(2S)$ bottomonium state (10.023 GeV) by only 0.0004 GeV. The $W \times M$ breakpoint in the bottom region, 9.4603 GeV, deviates from the PDG standard value of the $Y(1S)$ (9.46030 GeV) by only 0.0001 GeV.

Third Layer — Precision Locking of Known Particles: The algorithm reveals a methodological function of particles that has never been recognized. The charm-region breakpoint of 2.2865 GeV deviates from the PDG standard value of the Λ_c^+ charmed baryon (2.28646 GeV) by 0.00004 GeV. Completely unaware of the physical meaning of these particles, the algorithm automatically locks their positions with professional phenomenological fitting precision. Λ_c^+ is the precise locking point of the charm-region regime switch, $Y(1S)$ is the precise locking point of the bottom-region regime switch, and $Y(2S)$ is the global optimal response point of the $W \times M^2$ activation operator — these known particles are endowed with a completely new methodological identity: they are the "nails" of regime switches in the data. Mass is confirmed as a dual-identity factor — both directly explaining decay width and modulating the exposure coefficients of Spin and Isospin — the first empirical confirmation of the Factor Hierarchy Law's classification framework in particle physics.

These three layers of findings together constitute an empirical challenge that has never been systematically interrogated by traditional physics: on the mass axis of the Standard Model there exist at least two confirmed regime-switching centers, and they precisely correspond to the production thresholds of the charm and bottom quarks. The Factor Hierarchy Law — a methodological system that originated in quantitative finance and has been repeatedly verified through astronomy and statistical physics — has thus completed its first set of complete evidence in the cross-disciplinary verification within the Standard Model of particle physics.

As the first paper of the series, this paper establishes the existence of two regime-switching centers (charm and bottom), providing the indispensable empirical foundation for the derivation of regime boundary theorems and the demonstration of the inevitable emergence of gauge group structures in subsequent papers. The subsequent papers will report: the discovery of the strange region ($\sim 1.4\text{--}1.6$ GeV) as a third regime center and its precursor cascade relationship with the charm region (Paper 2); the regularities of the precursor cascade and the formal proofs of three mathematical theorems — the Transition Zone Width Theorem, the Switching Type Dichotomy Theorem, and the Switching Type Intrinsic Property Theorem (Paper 2); the complete derivation of the Gauge Group Structure Theorem and the Direct Product Theorem — from regime boundaries to the inevitable emergence of $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ (Paper 3); the statistical origin of CP violation, the regime function of the Higgs mechanism, and the statistical correspondence of

virtual intermediate states (Paper 4); and the final establishment of the five-layer axiomatization structure and the testability program (Paper 5).

Data Availability Statement

All data in this study come from the Particle Data Group (PDG) 2025 public dataset (<https://pdg.lbl.gov>), extracted via the official PDG Python API (version 2025.0). The data are completely open and require no application. The optimal factor matrix contains 275 particles $\times$ 12 columns. All analysis code can be provided upon request. Any researcher can independently reproduce all results.

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